days earlier. It was more than likely that a strike against the ballistic missiles sites in Cuba would have provoked the Soviet use of nuclear weapons. The General Staff in Moscow had a draft order ready to be signed allowing Soviet commanders in Cuba to use tactical nuclear weapons, which had arrived in Cuba as well, if they were attacked. The nuclear war that Kennedy was so desperate to avoid would have broken out almost immediately if his strike plan had been carried out. Luckily, he decided to take a pause.